

Heidegger on Being and the World

Bob Brandom (rbrandom@pitt.edu)

Week 1: August 26, 2026

Wednesdays at 1pm in 1008 B, Cathedral of Learning

The course website, with a week-by-week schedule and all the readings, is available at:

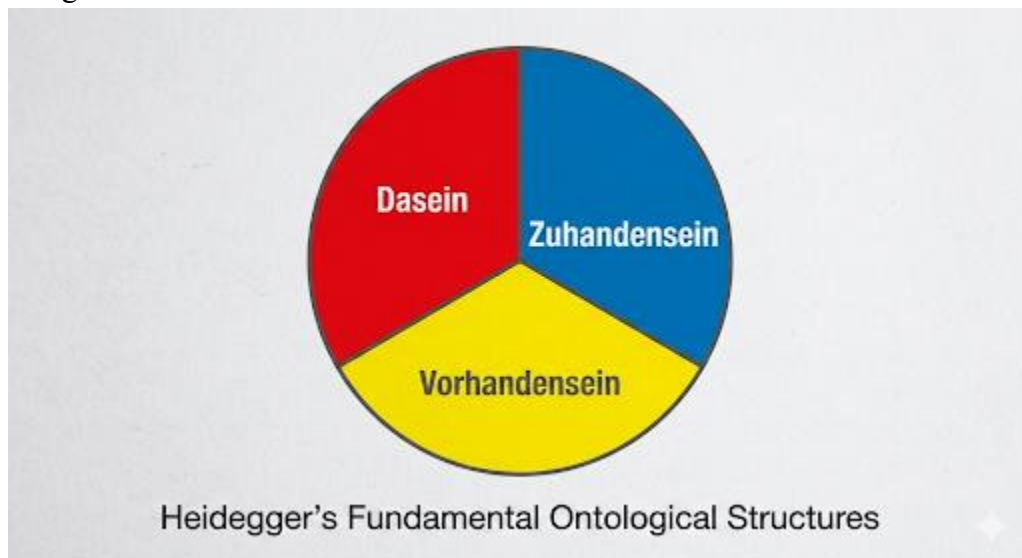
<https://spaceofreasons.netlify.app/courses/heidegger-2026/>

(Or by drilling down under the “Courses” tab from my Pitt website:

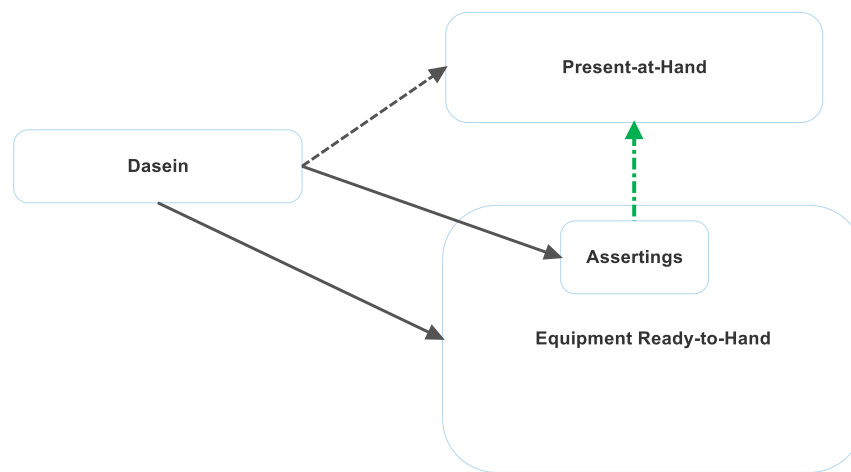
<https://sites.pitt.edu/~rbrandom/>

Plan:

1. "To think is to confine yourself to a single thought that one day stands still like a star in the world's sky." Heidegger
2. The ontological difference is between beings and their Being.
The ontic/ontological distinction lines up with that between beings and their Being.
On the broadly epistemic dimension, beings are *discovered* and Being is *disclosed*.
3. The ontotheological mistake: treating Being as a being.
4. Heidegger has a three-part ontology, comprising Dasein (us) and *two* kinds of beings whose Being is *not* that of Dasein:



5. Being has a history: the metaphysics of presence.
6. Vorhandensein: presence, or the occurrent.
7. Dasein, as *ontologically* self-conscious Being.
8. Zuhandensein: Equipment and the functional affordances of the ready-to-hand.
9. Normativity, Kant, and the Neokantians.
10. Heidegger's pragmatism and how presence precipitates out of what is *zuhanden*.



11. From Kant's representational version of appearance/reality to concealed/unconcealed.
12. Falling and authenticity.
13. Life: Heidegger was born. He wrote. He was a Nazi. He died.
14. Work. The Kehre.